BIOMECHANICS (EPHE 341)

Introduction and Review

Course administration, and the review you need to have done before next class.

Introduction

Today's objectives

Section 1 — Course administration

- Course details
- Assessment

Section 2 — Review (homework)

- Basic math
- Trigonometry
- Basic functional anatomy
- Linear kinematics

Introduction

Biomechanics 341

Lectures	Monday and Thursday, 1:00–2:20 pm
Labs	Begin this week
Office hours	TBD
Email	klimstra@uvic.ca
Brightspace	Lectures, readings, problem sets

> Everything that is not said out loud in class is on Brightspace: the slide decks, the readings and every problem set. The decks are also live web pages — the figures with sliders only work there.

Introduction

What is biomechanics?

> The study of the effects of **internal and external forces** on the human body in movement and at rest.

Bio — any biological system.

Mechanics — the branch of the physical sciences concerned with the state of rest or motion of bodies subjected to the action of forces. Rigid body, fluid, deformable body.

The word to notice is **internal**. External forces can be measured — you stand on a plate and read the number. Internal ones cannot, and they are the ones that decide whether a tendon tears or a hip replacement lasts.

> Almost everything this field knows about what the inside of a body is doing is *calculated*, not measured. The last three lectures of this course are how that calculation works.

Introduction

Qualitative and quantitative biomechanics

Qualitative — describing movement without numbers. A coach watching a stride, a clinician watching a gait. That is EPHE 201.

Quantitative — putting numbers on it. That is EPHE 341.

Neither is the better one. A clinician has fifteen minutes and needs a judgement; a researcher testing a new rehabilitation protocol needs a measurement. Each answers questions the other cannot.

What the quantitative approach buys is the ability to be **wrong in a checkable way** — which is the whole reason this course spends so much time on units and sanity checks.

Introduction

Statics and dynamics

Statics — the branch of physical science concerned with bodies, static or at rest, upon which **balanced** forces act.

Static equilibrium — we will be able to quantify forces and torques for objects in static equilibrium. *Lecture 19.*

Dynamics — the study of the relationship between motion and the forces affecting motion. It is the combined study of kinetics and kinematics. *Lecture 20.*

> Constant velocity counts as statics. That surprises people, and it is the single most useful thing on this slide: the forces balance whenever the acceleration is zero, moving or not.

Introduction

What is kinematics?

> The area of study that examines the **spatial and temporal** components of motion — position, velocity, acceleration — **without regard to force**.

Measures of movement.

Kinesis, from the Ancient Greek, is motion or movement; *kineo* is to move, to put in motion.

A video of a jump is kinematics. It tells you how high he went and how fast he was travelling when he left the floor, and nothing at all about why.

Introduction

What is kinetics?

> The study of bodies in motion with respect to **mass, force and energy**.

Measures of the causes and effects of movement.

Kinematics describes; kinetics explains. Roughly half this course is each, and the two meet in the last three lectures, where measured motion and a measured force are put together to work out what the joints were doing.

Introduction

Quantitative biomechanics — applications

To measure or predict internal and external forces in a variety of settings. For example:

- **Occupational and industrial** — ergonomics.
- **Clinical** — assess rehabilitation methods.
- **Sport** — assess performance techniques.

> All three are the same question asked by different people: *what is this doing to the inside of the body, and would a change help?*

Introduction

Quantitative biomechanics techniques

We will be discussing and using measurement techniques in biomechanics.

- Force plates and force transducers
- Motion capture, in two and three dimensions
- Electromyography
- Accelerometers and gyroscopes

Each one is a lecture of its own later in the term, and each one appears in this deck series on **real recordings** rather than on diagrams — a measured walking stride, a measured jump, a measured sprint.

> When a figure in this course is a simulation rather than a recording, it says so on the figure.

Introduction

EPHE 341 lecture topics

Force forces	**Moment of Force / Torque** angular kinetics 1	**Static Equilibrium** static analysis	**Friction** linear kinetics 1	**Linear Kinematics** calculus and kinematics	**Angular Kinematics** angular kinematics	**General Kinematics** general kinematics
Basic Calculus calculus and kinematics ↗	**Projectile motion** projectile motion	**Anthropometry** angular kinetics 2	**Moment of Inertia** angular kinetics 3	**Dynamic Equilibrium** dynamic analysis	**Work / Energy** work energy power	**Power** work energy power ↗
Impulse Momentum linear kinetics 2	**3D Forces and Moments** gait analysis	**Current measurement tools** sensors and data acquisition	**Force measurement** forces ↗	**3D motion analysis** gait analysis ↗	**Electromyography** electromyography	**Mechanical properties of muscle** muscle mechanics
Gait analysis gait analysis ↗	**Signals** signals					

His slide 11, with the lectures attached. Every topic on that list is now an interactive deck — **18 of them** — and this is the only slide in the course that can say so. That is the argument for converting the introduction last: a map is not much use until there is something to map.

How this course works

A text you do not have to buy, problem sets that are not graded, and a tutor that is open all night.

How This Course Works

The optional text

The lectures will present the laws of physics that will be used to analyse human movement. **All test content will come from the lecture notes.** The lectures can be supplemented by the optional course text.

> *Biomechanics of Sport and Exercise* — McGinnis

Three reasons for choosing it:

- it presents mechanics well;
- it covers some important concepts in qualitative analysis;
- it will be useful in future courses.

How This Course Works

Evaluation

Formal exams — 65 %

- 2 in-class tests, 25 % each (29 January, 5 March)
- 1 in-class final, 15 % (2 April)

Laboratory assignments — 35 %

Labs begin this week.

How This Course Works

Problem sets

Whenever a mechanics concept comes up in class I will go over a few examples to show you how I would solve any given problem.

I will also post problem sets for you to practise. **These will not be graded.**

However, the test material will be based on the problem sets, so it is important that you have a good knowledge of this material.

> Those two sentences are not in tension: the problem sets are the practice, the test is the performance.

How This Course Works

The Biomechanics Tutor

Tutor and problem sets available online.

How the Tutor works: **leading questions**. It does not just mark your final answer — it walks you through the step you got stuck on.

mklimstra.github.io/Biomech-tutor

> One warning you will be glad of. The Tutor grades your number against an exact range with **no tolerance**, so enter the rounded value it is expecting, not every digit your calculator produced.

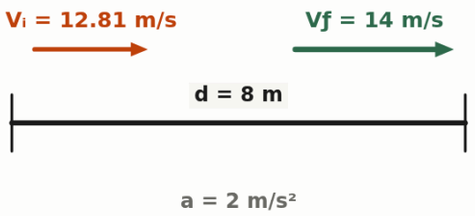
How This Course Works

Basic problem solving in biomechanics

1. Read the problem carefully to understand what is asked.
2. Write down what is to be determined.
3. When helpful, draw a diagram.
4. Identify and write down helpful formulas related to the variable that is to be determined.
5. Write down all the given information relevant to those formulas.
6. Select the formula(s) that contain the given variables and the unknown variable. *If a workable formula cannot be found, it may be necessary to return to step 1 for more analysis of the given data.*
7. If a workable formula can be found, write it out and substitute the known quantities.
8. Use basic math (algebra) to solve for the unknown variable.
9. Check to see if the answer makes sense.
10. Box in the answer and check the units.

How This Course Works

The same eleven steps, run on one problem



step 11

V_i = 12.81 m/s. √(m²/s²) is m/s, so the units come out right too.

1. **Read the problem carefully to understand what is asked.**
2. **Write down what is to be determined.**
3. **When helpful, draw a diagram.**
4. **Identify and write down helpful formulas related to the variable.**
5. **Write down all the given information relevant to those formulas.**
6. **Select the formula that contains the givens and the unknown.**
7. **If no workable formula can be found, return to step 1.**
8. **Write it out and substitute the known quantities.**
9. **Use basic algebra to solve for the unknown.**
10. **Check to see if the answer makes sense.**
11. **Box the answer and check the units.**

His slide 16, one step at a time, on the Tutor's first Basic Math question.

Step **11 of 11**

Eleven steps, and the two that matter most are the ones that look like filler. **Step 6** is where the problem is actually solved: two of the three kinematics equations need a time nobody gave you, so there is only one left and no choice to agonise over. **Step 10** is the one that catches mistakes — including the one on his own slide 38.

How This Course Works

Background material (homework)

Most of this material should have been learned in math courses in high school and is **crucial** to being able to do biomechanics successfully. It is your responsibility to be able to know how to manipulate numbers and equations successfully.

- Basic math
- Trigonometry
- Basic functional anatomy
- Linear kinematics

> The students who find this course hard are almost never the ones who find *mechanics* hard. They are the ones who cannot rearrange an equation at speed. That is fixable, and now is when it is cheap to fix.

How This Course Works

Before next class

Homework

- Review the following slides related to basic math and anatomy.
- Work on the problem sets for basic math and trigonometry.
- Review the lecture on linear kinematics.

Basic math

Real numbers, exponents, and three kinds of equation. Nothing here is new; all of it has to be fast.

Basic Math

What is reviewed here

The basic math concepts reviewed will be:

- Properties of real numbers
- Laws of exponents
- Solving equations for one unknown
- Solving equations for multiple unknowns
- Solving quadratic equations

> Every one of these turns up in a mechanics problem before reading week. The exponents are needed for moments of inertia, the quadratic for anything thrown.

Basic Math

Properties of real numbers

Quite simply, real numbers are all the numbers that we will deal with in biomechanics, and exist on a continuum from $-\infty$ to $+\infty$.

We can add, subtract, multiply and divide these numbers.

- Commutative properties
- Associative properties
- Distributive properties

Basic Math

Commutative properties

Changing the order of the operands does not change the end result. Said another way: in situations of strict addition or multiplication, number order is not important.

Addition

$$a + b = b + a$$

Multiplication

$$a \times b = b \times a$$

Notice what is *not* on the list: subtraction and division. $a - b \neq b - a$, and that is the source of half the sign errors in the course.

Basic Math

Associative properties

Within an expression containing two or more occurrences in a row of the same operator, the order in which the operations are performed does not matter as long as the sequence of the operands is not changed. Or whichever way the numbers are grouped to perform the operation, the answer will still be the same.

Addition

$$(a + b) + c = a + (b + c)$$

Multiplication

$$(a \times b) \times c = a \times (b \times c)$$

Basic Math

Distributive property

If a number is multiplied by numbers in brackets, we need to multiply each number in the bracket by the number outside of the brackets.

$$a(b + c) = (a \times b) + (a \times c)$$

This is the one that breaks. Students multiply the first term in the bracket and forget the second, and it costs them in every force-resolution problem for the rest of the term.

Basic Math

Theorems, and the laws of exponents

Based on the commutative, associative and distributive properties, some basic theorems can be developed — the sixteen operations with real numbers on his slide 24.

And then the **eight laws of exponents**, which are the ones you will actually use:

$$x^0 = 1 \qquad x^{-n} = 1 / x^n$$

$$x^m \cdot x^n = x^{m+n} \qquad x^m / x^n = x^{m-n}$$

$$(x^m)^n = x^{mn} \qquad x^{m/n} = \sqrt[n]{(x^m)}$$

Every one of the twenty-four is checked on the next slide rather than asserted — both sides evaluated, for any base and any pair of powers you choose.

Basic Math

The same twenty-four, evaluated

1 $c^n \cdot c^m = c^{n+m}$
$2^3 \times 2^5 = 2^{3+5} = 2^8$
✓ 256 = 256

2 $x^0 = 1$
$4^0 = 1$
✓ 1 = 1

3 $x^{-n} = 1/x^n$
$3^{-2} = 1/3^2$
✓ 0.125 = 0.125

4 $c^m / c^n = c^{m-n}$
$2^7 / 2^4 = 2^3$
✓ 0.25 = 0.25

5 $(c^n)^m = c^{nm}$
$(5^2)^3 = 5^6$
✓ 32768 = 32768

6 $(c \cdot d)^n = c^n \cdot d^n$
$(2 \times 3)^4 = 2^4 \times 3^4$
✓ 216 = 216

7 $(c/d)^n = c^n / d^n$
$(3/4)^5 = 3^5 / 4^5$
✓ 0.125 = 0.125

8 $x^{m/n} = \sqrt[n]{(x^m)}$
$3^{4/2} = \sqrt{(3^4)}$
✓ 1.515717 = 1.515717

all eight hold, with his numbers and with these

The sliders change the base and the two powers · law 2 has no power to change and law 8 needs a whole root, so those two ignore them

The eight laws of exponents | The sixteen theorems

The base — 2
The first power — 3
The second power — 5

Twenty-four identities, and every one of them holds — with his numbers and with any others you slide to. That is worth saying out loud: his review content is **right**, and the only two things this deck corrects in fifty-nine slides are a quadratic's roots and a cosine-law answer.

Basic Math

Solving equations for one unknown

When you encounter an equation with a variable of unknown value, the following procedure can be used to solve for the unknown value.

1. **Isolate the variable** by manipulating the equation. *Rule: whatever you do to one side of the equation, you must do to the other side.* Use the algebraic properties from the previous pages.
2. **Solve** for the unknown value.

Example: (3x + 7)/11 = 2, find x

A. multiply both sides by 11 $3x + 7 = 2(11)$

B. subtract 7 from both sides $3x = 2(11) - 7$

C. divide both sides by 3 $x = (2(11) - 7)/3$

$$x = (22 - 7)/3 = 15/3 = \mathbf{5}$$

Basic Math

Solving equations for multiple unknowns

When you have an equation with two or more variables of unknown value, you need **a number of equations equal to the number of unknown values**, each containing the variables.

1. Isolate one variable by manipulating the equation.
2. Substitute the term in place of the isolated variable into a second equation.
3. Solve for the other unknown value.
4. Back-substitute the value of the second variable into the first equation to solve for the first variable.

Example: 1) $x + y = 3$ 2) $2x + y = 4$, find x and y

1. isolate $x = 3 - y$

2. substitute into 2) $2(3 - y) + y = 4$

3. solve $6 - 2y + y = 4 \rightarrow y = 2$

4. back-substitute $x + 2 = 3 \rightarrow \mathbf{x = 1}$

Basic Math

Solving quadratic equations

When you have an equation in the form $ax^2 + bx + c = 0$, where a, b and c are real numbers, it is known as a **quadratic equation**, and once solved will yield **two values for x**.

This becomes clear if you graph a quadratic equation: the curve crosses the x-axis twice.

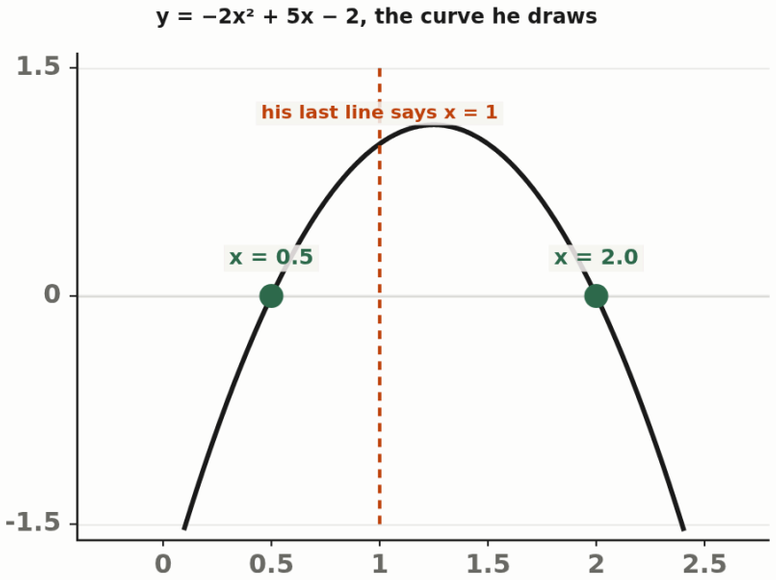
$$x = (-b \pm \sqrt{(b^2 - 4ac)}) \,/\, 2a$$

His worked case is $y(f) = -2x^2 + 5x - 2$, which crosses the axis at $x = ½$ and $x = 2$.

> Quadratics turn up the moment anything is thrown: a projectile is at a given height **twice**, once going up and once coming down, and the two roots are those two times. That is why you cannot take the positive root and go home.

Basic Math

His three examples, with the answer drawn



$-2x^2 + 5x - 2 = 0$, find x

the quadratic formula

$x = (-b \pm \sqrt{(b^2 - 4ac)}) / 2a$

substitute

$x = (-5 \pm \sqrt{(25 - 16)}) / -4$

so

$x = (-5 \pm 3) / -4 = 0.5$ or 2

$x = 0.5$ and $x = 2.0$

his slide concludes $x = ½$ and $x = 1$

The formula on his slide is right and he applies it right. Only the concluding line is wrong — and his own graph, printed beside it, cuts the axis at ½ and 2. Reading the answer off the picture would have caught it, which is his own step eleven: check to see if the answer makes sense.

One unknown | Two unknowns | **A quadratic**

Three equations, three shapes of answer: a point on a line, a crossing of two lines, and the two places a curve cuts the axis. Drawing the answer is not decoration — it is the check. His slide 30 applies the quadratic formula correctly and then writes down the wrong pair of roots, and the graph printed on the same slide disagrees with the sentence underneath it.

Trigonometry

The part of the review that you will use every single week, because almost every force in this course arrives at an angle.

Trigonometry

Basic geometric laws

1. Two lines are **perpendicular** when they are positioned 90° to each other.
2. When two lines are **parallel** they will never intersect.
3. When two lines intersect the **opposing angles are the same**.
4. When two lines intersect, the sum of the angles created by the intersection will equal **360°**.
5. When two lines intersect, the sum of the angles along one line created by the intersection will equal **180°**.

Trigonometry

Basic geometric laws, continued

6. When a line intersects two parallel lines a **Z pattern** forms and the corresponding angles are shown below.
7. The intersection of three non-parallel lines will make a **triangle**.
8. The sum of the interior angles of a triangle will always equal **180°**.

The Z rule and the 180° rule between them are how you find an angle you were never given — which is most of what free body diagrams ask you to do.

Trigonometry

Trigonometric functions of a right angle triangle

$\cos\theta$ = adjacent / hypotenuse

$\sin\theta$ = opposite / hypotenuse

$\tan\theta$ = opposite / adjacent

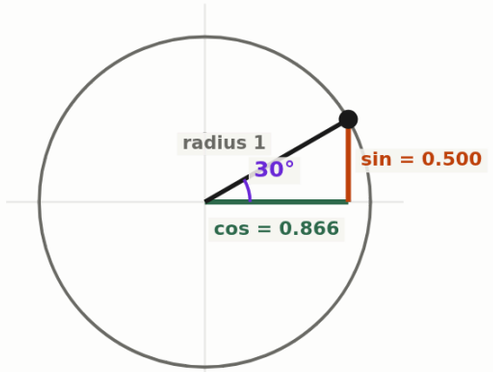
Pythagorean theorem

$\text{hypotenuse}^2 = \text{adjacent}^2 + \text{opposite}^2$

Below is a graphical representation of cosine, sine and tangent for values of θ from 0° to 360° (π = 180°). These graphs can be memorised and used to estimate when a calculator is not available. Notice that sine and cosine oscillate between 1 and −1.

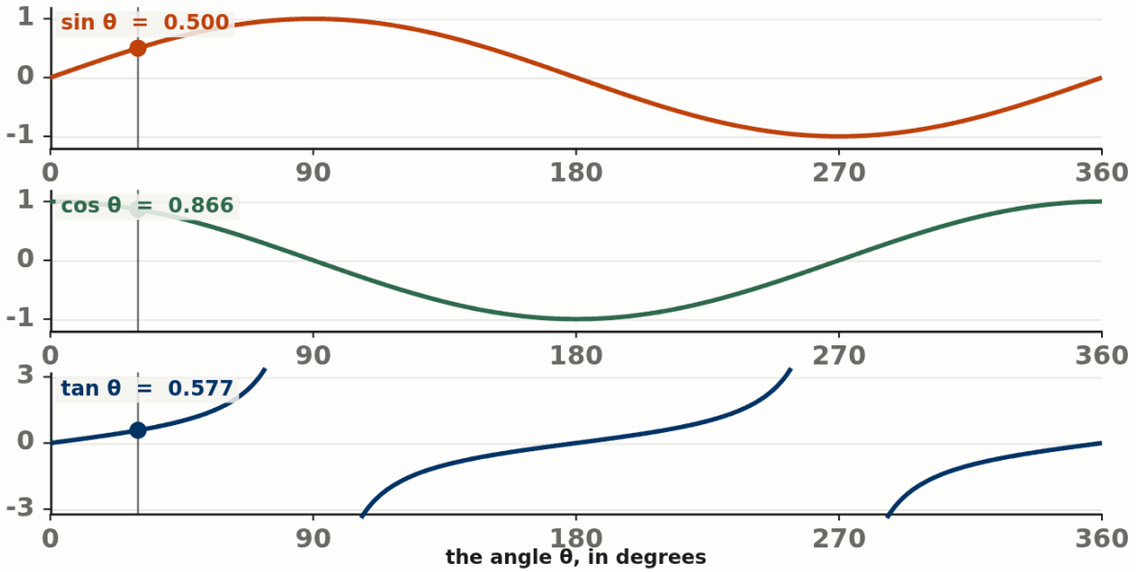
Trigonometry

Where those three graphs come from



his slide 35, against the circle

0°	0 = 0.000	1 = 1.000	0 = 0.000
30°	1/2 = 0.500	√3/2 = 0.866	√3/3 = 0.577
45°	√2/2 = 0.707	√2/2 = 0.707	1 = 1.000
60°	√3/2 = 0.866	1/2 = 0.500	√3 = 1.732
90°	1 = 1.000	0 = 0.000	—



One point, one circle · its height is the sine, its sideways distance the cosine, and the slope of the radius the tangent · which is why tan blows up at 90°, where the radius is vertical and has no sideways distance left to divide by

The angle θ **30°**

0° | **30°** | 45° | 60° | 90°

▶ Go round

Sine, cosine and tangent are not three functions to memorise, they are **one point going round one circle**. The height of the point is the sine, its sideways distance is the cosine, and the tangent is one divided by the other. Press the special angles and watch his slide 35 light up a row at a time — those five rows are five places on this circle, which is a great deal easier than learning a table.

Trigonometry

Special right angle triangle cases

From the trigonometric functions and graphs for a right angle triangle we can develop some special cases that can be memorised to help solve trigonometry problems.

θ	sinθ	cosθ	tanθ
0°	0	1	0
30°	1/2	√3/2	√3/3
45°	√2/2	√2/2	1
60°	√3/2	1/2	√3
90°	1	0	—

The general triangle can be used to solve for any unknown side if any side and angle is known. From the graphs of sine, cosine and tangent we can determine some important values for specific values of θ, and these values can be used to create special triangles that can be memorised.

> The 30–60–90 triangle has sides 1, ½ and √3/2. The 45–45–90 triangle has sides 1, √2/2 and √2/2. His Example 1 is the first of these.

Trigonometry

Trigonometric functions of a non right angle triangle

The trigonometric functions for **any** triangle are as follows:

$$\alpha + \beta + \gamma = 180^\circ$$

Cosine law

$$a^2 = b^2 + c^2 - 2bc \cdot \cos\alpha$$

$$b^2 = a^2 + c^2 - 2ac \cdot \cos\beta$$

$$c^2 = a^2 + b^2 - 2ab \cdot \cos\gamma$$

Sine law

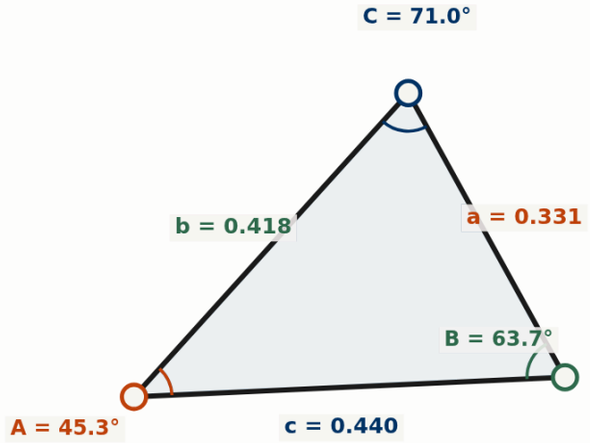
$$a/\sin\alpha = b/\sin\beta = c/\sin\gamma$$

These functions are true for all triangles. They are best memorised and used at all times when attempting to solve for unknown values of a triangle.

> Which one you use is decided by **what you were given**, not by what you want. Two angles and a side → the sine law. Two sides and the angle between them → the cosine law.

Trigonometry

One triangle, all three relations at once



drag any corner

the angles always sum to 180°

45.3° + 63.7° + 71.0° = 180.0°

the sine law — a/sinA = b/sinB = c/sinC

0.466 0.466 0.466 (all one number)

the cosine law — c² = a² + b² − 2ab·cosC

0.331² + 0.418² − 2(0.331)(0.418)cos71.0° → c = 0.440, and c measures 0.440

Which law you use is decided by what you were given, not by what you want: two angles and a side → the sine law; two sides and the angle between them → the cosine law; a right angle → either, or sin, cos and tan.

The sine and cosine laws | The right-angle functions

Make it right-angled | **Make it equilateral**

One triangle, three laws, all true at once. Drag a corner: the three sine-law ratios stay equal to each other while every one of them changes, and the cosine law reproduces the side you can measure. **Which law you reach for is decided by what you were given** — two angles and a side, the sine law; two sides and the angle between them, the cosine law.

Trigonometry

Example 1: right angle triangle · Example 2: non-right

Example 1. A right angle triangle with a hypotenuse of 1 m and an angle of 60°. Find the other two sides.

$$\text{opposite} = 1 \cdot \sin 60^\circ = 0.87 \text{ m}$$

$$\text{adjacent} = 1 \cdot \cos 60^\circ = 0.50 \text{ m}$$

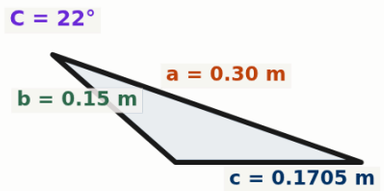
Example 2. A triangle with sides of 0.30 m and 0.15 m and an angle of 22° between them. Find the third side.

$$c^2 = 0.30^2 + 0.15^2 - 2(0.30)(0.15)\cos 22^\circ$$

Trigonometry

The same two examples, drawn to scale

Example 2: a non-right-angle triangle



his 0.3227 m, to the same scale

What is the length of side c, given angle C = 22°, side a = 0.30 m and side b = 0.15 m?

two sides and the angle between them, so this is the cosine law

$c^2 = a^2 + b^2 - 2ab \cdot \cos C$

$c^2 = 0.30^2 + 0.15^2 - 2(0.30)(0.15)\cos 22°$

$c^2 = 0.1125 - 0.0834 = 0.029053$

c = 0.1705 m

his slide prints 0.3227 m

Look at the picture rather than the arithmetic. Drawn to his own givens, c comes out clearly shorter than the 0.30 m side — and the sketch on his slide 38 shows exactly that. The dashed line is what 0.3227 m would measure; it is longer than every side of the triangle it is supposed to close.

His Example 1 | **His Example 2**

His Example 1 reproduces to the digit. **Example 2 does not:** the cosine law with his own three givens gives **0.1705 m** where the slide prints 0.3227 m. The useful part is not the correction, it is the check — his own eleventh step of problem solving is "check to see if the answer makes sense", and a side of 0.32 m cannot close a triangle whose other two sides are 0.30 and 0.15 with only 22° between them. Drawing it to scale catches the error in one second.

Anatomical planes, axis and position

Three planes, three axes, and a vocabulary for saying which way a limb went.

Planes and Axes

Planes and axis system

The planes and axis system will be necessary for describing movement in **2D and 3D**.

Plane	Axis
Sagittal	Transverse
Frontal	Anteroposterior (AP)
Transverse	Longitudinal

The diagrams and description that follow are on McGinnis pp. 158–171.

Sagittal — divides the body into left and right. Most of walking happens here, which is why most of this course is two-dimensional.

Frontal — divides front from back.

Transverse — divides top from bottom.

Planes and Axes

Axis system

> An axis is the straight line where **two planes intersect**. The distance an object is along a certain axis is an important reference position.

An axis is also a line **about which an object may rotate**.

Those two sentences describe the same line, and that is not a coincidence. A joint that moves in one plane rotates about the axis perpendicular to it.

> Flexing your knee is movement in the *sagittal* plane about a *left–right* axis. Say it with your own knee.

Planes and Axes

The three axes, one at a time

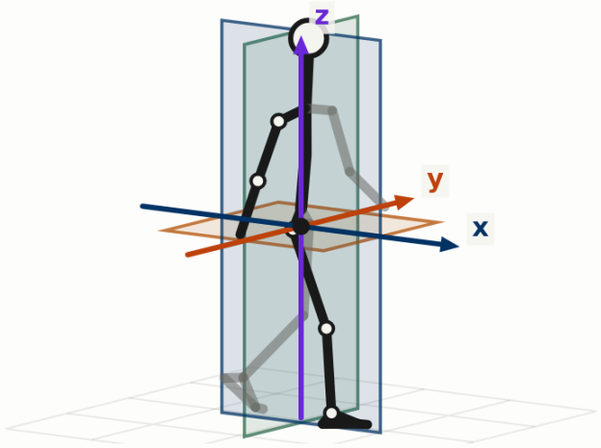
- The line of intersection of the **sagittal and frontal** planes makes the **z-axis**, or vertical axis. Distance along this axis is a measure of **up and down**.
- The line of intersection of the **frontal and transverse** planes is the **y-axis**. Distance along it is a measure of **left and right**.
- The line of intersection of the **sagittal and transverse** planes is the **x-axis**. Distance along it is a measure of **front and back**.

That is the convention every figure in this course uses, and it is the convention the motion-capture system in the lab writes its files in. When you open a data file in week ten, these are the columns.

> Every number you will ever read off a marker, a force plate or an accelerometer is a distance or a force *along one of these three lines*.

Planes and Axes

The same build-up, on somebody who is actually moving



0 % of the stride · drag to turn

his slides 39 to 46, in one figure

- **the sagittal plane**
  divides left from right
- **the frontal plane**
  divides front from back
- **the transverse plane**
  divides top from bottom

- **the z axis**
  where the sagittal and frontal planes meet
  distance along it is a measure of up and down
- **the y axis**
  where the frontal and transverse planes meet
  distance along it is a measure of left and right
- **the x axis**
  where the sagittal and transverse planes meet
  distance along it is a measure of front and back

A measured walking stride · the planes are fixed in the room and the body moves through them, which is his slides 47 to 50: the joint axes go with the limbs, not with the diagram

Where in the stride — 0 %

Everything | Sagittal | Frontal | Transverse | z | y | x

▶ Walk

Three planes, three axes, and a real person walking through them. The convention is his, off slides 41 to 46: **z** where sagittal and frontal meet, up and down; **y** where frontal and transverse meet, left and right; **x** where sagittal and transverse meet, front and back. Drag to turn it; press Walk and the planes stay put while the limbs swing out of them.

Planes and Axes

Joint axes move with the limb

Joint axes will move when the limbs are in a different anatomical location.

It is important to have a basic understanding of anatomy to know how to determine the movement of body and limb with respect to joint axes and anatomical planes.

> Imagining a **wheel** helps: the plane of the movement is the plane of the wheel, and the axis is the hub. Raise your arm out to the side and the elbow's wheel has turned with it — the same joint, the same flexion, a different plane.

Planes and Axes

And most real movement is in none of them

While it is important to know the basic anatomical planes, when someone moves, movement may occur in a **different plane** about a **different axis**.

A golf swing is the standard example: the club travels in a plane that is neither sagittal nor frontal nor transverse, tilted somewhere between them, and the shoulders rotate about an axis perpendicular to *that* plane.

> The three cardinal planes are a **vocabulary**, not a claim about what bodies do. Naming a diagonal movement means naming its components in the three planes you already have words for.

Planes and Axes

And the plane you watch from changes what you see

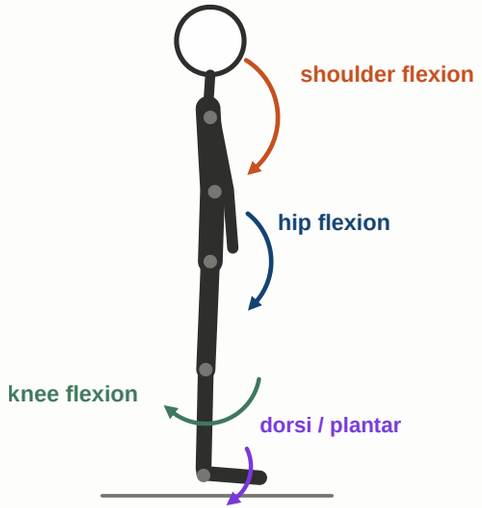
Viewing joint movement from different planes will give you a different perspective of the movement.

A shoulder abduction filmed from the front is a clean arc. The same abduction filmed from the side is a limb that barely moves. Neither camera is lying; each one is projecting a three-dimensional movement onto its own plane.

> This is the reason every two-dimensional analysis in this course states which plane it is in — and the reason the last three lectures keep asking how much of the movement actually stayed in that plane.

Planes and Axes

Sagittal plane joint actions



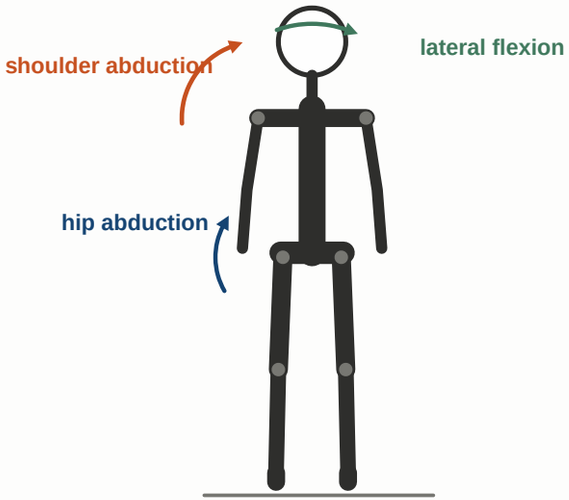
Movement in the **sagittal** plane, about a **transverse** (left–right) axis:

- flexion
- extension
- hyperextension
- plantar flexion
- dorsiflexion

At the wrist, elbow, shoulder, hip, knee, trunk, neck and ankle.

Planes and Axes

Frontal plane joint actions

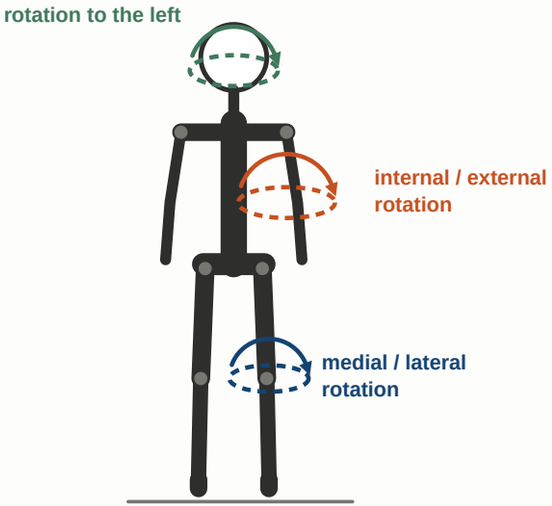


Movement in the **frontal** plane, about an **anteroposterior** (front–back) axis:

- abduction and adduction
- ulnar and radial deviation
- inversion and eversion
- elevation and depression
- upward and downward rotation
- lateral flexion to the left and right

Planes and Axes

Transverse plane joint actions



Movement in the **transverse** plane, about a **longitudinal** (up–down) axis:

- internal and external rotation
- pronation and supination
- horizontal abduction and adduction
- rotation to the right and to the left

Planes and Axes

Joint actions and their planes and axes

Plane of motion	Axis	Joint actions
Sagittal	Transverse	flexion · extension · hyperextension · plantar flexion · dorsiflexion
Frontal	Anteroposterior	abduction · adduction · ulnar deviation · radial deviation · inversion · eversion · elevation · depression · upward rotation · downward rotation · lateral flexion to the left · lateral flexion to the right
Transverse	Longitudinal	internal rotation · external rotation · pronation · supination · horizontal abduction · horizontal adduction · rotation to the right · rotation to the left

Planes and Axes

What to take away

- Biomechanics measures the **outside** of a body and computes the **inside**.
- **Kinematics** describes motion; **kinetics** explains it. You need both.
- Which trigonometric law you use is decided by **what you were given**.
- An **axis** is where two planes meet, and it is the line a joint turns about.
- The algebra is not the hard part of this course, but it is the part that costs marks. Fix it now.
- **Draw the answer.** Both of the errors in this lecture would have been caught by one sketch.

Planes and Axes

Next

Next class is **sensors and data acquisition** — how a force becomes a number, and what happens to it on the way. After that, calculus and kinematics, and then forces, and from there the course is continuous to the end.

Work the basic math and trigonometry problem sets before next class, and review the linear kinematics lecture.